Kirill Lalayants

Data Scientist · ML & Finance

NES · Skoltech · ITMO

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Summary

I'm a Data Scientist at Sberbank CIB, applying ML to trading and pricing, with a strong interest in finance and economics. At Yandex Lavka, I optimized discounts (+5% Front Margin) and automated experiment setup. Previously, I conducted research at ITMO and led an R&D team.

Work Experience

Data Scientist, Sberbank CIB *May 2026 – Present*

– Develop and implement RL agents for trading desk pricing and optimization.

Data Scientist, Yandex Lavka *Jan 2026 – May 2026*

– Optimized discount levels using price elasticity estimates, increasing Front Margin by 5%, as confirmed by a large-scale A/B test.

– Automated experiment setup and approval, reducing preparation time from several hours to a few minutes.

– Built infrastructure for collecting and analyzing experiment results, along with dashboards for price elasticity analysis.

– Automated product selection for experiments based on sales volume and popularity.

Research Engineer, ITMO University *Jul 2022 – Jun 2025*

– Built a SLAM system from scratch for GPS-denied indoor UAV flights: adapted the algorithm and achieved 25 FPS on Jetson Xavier in real-world flights.

– Implemented safe RL for a manipulator in simulation, achieving a 95% grasp success rate and reducing collisions.

– Developed tools to calibrate tool and camera poses on a real manipulator, with errors below 1 mm.

– Developed socket segmentation from RGB-D point clouds, plane estimation and distance calculations in the robot coordinate frame; the system was used for automated connector insertion on a real manipulator.

Team Lead, BRIZ Project (NDA) *Dec 2023 – Jul 2024*

– Led the development of an autonomous docking system for two UAVs: achieved a docking success rate above 90% on real hardware and delivered a working prototype to the client.

– Assembled the team, set the roadmap, approved technical approaches, ran tests and worked with company leadership.

Achievements

- Contributor to Ultralytics (authors of YOLO).
- Winner, StarLine Hackathon "Autonomous Future" (2023).
- Winner, St. Petersburg Open Winter Robotics Competition (2022).

Education

2025–2027 **NES** — Master of Science, AI & FinTech
2025–2027 **Skoltech** — Master of Science, Data Science
2021–2025 **ITMO University** — Bachelor of Science, Robotics & AI

Skills

ML & robotics	RL, safe RL, computer vision, SLAM, ROS2
Econometrics & experiments	A/B testing, DiD, uplift modeling, price elasticity, time series
Quantitative finance	Portfolio optimization, asset pricing, VaR/CVaR
Tools	Python, SQL, Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, Jupyter, Git, Docker

Languages

English — Advanced (TOEFL 106/120); Russian — Native